

Element J

Documentation of Evaluation

Our supervisor stated that taking the expert opinions and suggestions into consideration will lead to an almost complete reiteration of our design. Our stakeholders expressed that the prototype is a good addition to her current collections of hydroponic units. The expert that we met, James Roberson of William S. Schmidt Outdoor Education Center, expressed to us that we needed to ask our client what exact type of plants are going to grow on the trellis and asked us to put dimensions on our CAD design. He also expressed to us that we should think about what we will do in the future with this design, basically asking if this design is recyclable. Another suggestion that he offered us was adjusting the pumping system and water pipes to limit the amount of splashing among the pumping system. We took in his considerations and advice that they gave us since they are an expert in this specific field. After review Mr. Roberson, our expert, suggested many aspects we had not taken into account and pointed out flaws within our design that would dramatically affect our final project. He directed us to put more focus on our pumping system by giving us questions to ask ourselves and our stakeholders. Additionally he also gave us a learning experience about what we should expect when we are given information on experts in many fields. Some conclusions that were drawn from what he said were that we need to figure out what plants need to be grown. We also need to figure out what nutrients are needed and create a strategy to reduce splashing around the basin. Look for alternatives for the trellis material that may be used depending on the plant we are growing. He also tells us to keep in mind about the repurposability of the design.

